

# 1

# What is Democracy? Why Democracy?

Democratic Politics - I  
(NCERT Book)

POLITICAL SCIENCE



*Right from the moment a person is born, he is affected by the political system of the place. The type of healthcare facilities we receive, the type of education we receive, the level of nutrition we receive, and the amount of freedom we enjoy, all of these things are impacted by the political system we live in. The majority of countries are democratic including India and for those who are not democratic, there are protests in favour of democracy there.*



## What's Inside

### Topic(s)

- ✓ Topic-wise Notes
- ✓ Related NCERT Qs
- ✓ Caution Points
- ✓ Source-based Examples

### Questions

- ✓ New Pattern Qs
- ✓ All Objective + Subjective Qs
- ✓ Diksha Qs
- ✓ Detailed Explanation

This is a **SAMPLE PDF** of our best-selling Educart Social Science Question Bank for 2024-25. Learn for free. 😊

From previous readings of political science books, students know that both types of governments exist in the world democratic and non-democratic. Students are also aware that various countries have shifted their model of governance from non-democratic to democratic. This chapter defines democracy and through various examples, encourages the students to identify its features. The most essential constituents of democracy have been underlined in this chapter. These constituents distinguish it from the non-democratic forms of government. The chapter also contrasts the features of a functioning democracy and ideal democracy. It leads to a broader concept of democracy with all essential features and principles.

Election procedures prevalent in various democracies and non-democratic nations across the world have also been detailed in the chapter in form of examples.

## TOPIC 1

### WHAT IS DEMOCRACY?

#### Learning Objectives

- ➔ Students will be introduced to various new terms like democracy, military rule, dictatorships, etc.
- ➔ Students will learn more details about democracy underlining different features.
- ➔ Students will learn to distinguish it from other forms of government.

#### Learning Outcomes

- ➔ Students will be able to classify various countries mentioned in the chapter into democratic and non-democratic governments.
- ➔ Students will be able to enlist different features of democracy.
- ➔ Students will have understood the peculiar cases of the political systems of Saudi Arabia, Myanmar and Chile.

Governments and political systems are broadly distinguished into two categories:

- (1) Democratic
- (2) Non-democratic

## The Long March episode - Democracy and Dictatorship- Two sides of the same coin?

by **MAJED IQBAL**

The weekend in Pakistan saw the much awaited long march take its turn to add fuel onto the fire of the on-going political crisis plaguing the country.

President Zardari had pledged to re-instate the deposed Chief Justice Mr. Chaudhry, who had been removed by Musharraf in the November state of emergency, within 30 days of taking office, but reneged on the promise, saying the justice would re-open the case of alleged corruption by his late wife Benazir Bhutto and his own which, initially, was granted by Musharraf in a potential power sharing deal.

### Power

The election of the PPP in power in January and the 'in-house' move of Zardari to Presidency was 'too hard done on' his promise during the election of re-instating the deposed judges of the PPP.

Whilst Musharraf was in power we saw parties only around the message that dictatorship was bad for the country and that it should be removed to guarantee 'real' progress. The message was not just for Musharraf but anyone with similar ambitions for dictatorial rule which had caused havoc in the country through the persecution of the war on terror with no consultation from the national assembly, raising justice in army trials above anyone who were mere

loyal to Musharraf, sending the heads of the two opposition parties into exile and sacking judges who would ouster President Musharraf's authority as un-constitutional.

### Democracy

Today, Democracy, through free and fair elections has brought Zardari, a renowned economist into the highest office of the country, allowed the bombing and killings in west which has seen 500,000 people displaced and thousands of innocent lives, women and children killed by American drones, bring to the public that American strikes are unacceptable as they take place from Afghanistan.

Whereas new information proves that the Pakistanis gave the green light to America to bomb the citizens of the country, banning media reporting against the government as was done with G8O and colluding with the army to crackdown on lawyers, activists and opposition parties calling for the re-instatement of the deposed chief justice.

### Chumpdown

What can the people of Pakistan expect next, even after the Chief Justice has been sworn back into power?

How can people put their confidence in Democracy for Pakistan, after the information minister, Sherry Rehman resigned in the wake of the growing clamours by government on protests by lawyers and opposition groups which speak volumes on how messy in the government see no difference in



• **PROTESTS:** Thousands of people took to the streets in Pakistan over the weekend the previous regime and the new one? Both Democracy and Dictatorship have wreaked havoc for Pakistan. These parties that questioned Dictatorship and contested

Democracies across the world have similar as well as peculiar features. The most important feature of a democracy is that its leaders are popularly chosen by its people. In other words, the citizens of the country choose their political representatives through voting and independent elections.

In these forms of government, leaders are either hereditary or chosen through forced or rigged election procedures without any choice. Democracy is a form of a political system where those who rule are elected by those who are ruled. Rulers are elected by the people in a democracy.

## A VOTER'S POWER IN A DEMOCRACY

**PRAMOD RAI**

Since the majority of the Indian population is below 35 years of age, it is the young Indians who have a bigger share of the responsibility in the progress of the nation. Their involvement will have a profound impact on the society.

A total of 1.25 billion people of the world's largest democracy will be casting their votes in hopes of a better future for themselves and a more peaceful and prosperous India. The right to vote is one of the most powerful weapons of our democratic set up, guaranteed and empowered by the Constitution. Under the principles and mechanisms of the Universal Adult Franchise, every Indian citizen above 18 years of age is empowered to cast their vote, irrespective of their religion, race, caste, gender, income, and place of birth.

According to Article 325 of the Universal Declaration of the human rights, "Every one has right to take part in the Government of his country directly or through freely chosen representatives".

Further, Article 25 of the International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights (ICCPR) says, "Every citizen shall have the right and opportunity without any discrimination mentioned in Article 2, and without unreasonable restrictions to take part in the conduct of public affairs, directly or through freely chosen representatives".

Article 328 of the Indian Constitution says that "The election in the House of People and the legislative Assembly of states is to be held on the basis of adult suffrage". The Election Commission of India (EC) is an independent body responsible to conduct free and fair elections. The body is constitutionally mandated to take



care of everything related to the elections, including supervision, control, and direction of the elections. Despite the Election Commission and its duties, voters from the disadvantaged community, who are economically and socially backward, are reluctant to meet parties to political parties who exploit the voters' voting rights to adopt unfair and unethical means. Even after 70 years of independence, democratic awareness of the people of the grassroots level is pitiful. A majority of Indians fails to understand the power of their voting rights.

Elections are of paramount significance for the survival of a democratic state. Through this mechanism, citizens get the chance to choose and decide on the governing author-

ities or the representatives whom they can bestow their trust on.

Although the dynamic Indian democracy with temporary representatives from the different segments of society, has mechanized the people around the globe, the underprivileged still continue to be manipulated by the political parties. Many a truly horrendous and heinous history, from the British and the British, have catalogued a checklist of wrongs of a thing democracy to their book entitled "How Democracies Die". They argue that the 'non acceptance' of the voters' rights and aspirations is one of the signs of a dying democracy.

Since the majority of the Indian population is below 35 years of age, it is the young

Indians who have a bigger share of the responsibility in the progress of the nation. Their involvement will have a profound impact on the society in terms of technological, technological transformation. Our responsibility is to participate in the government's transformation process. It is better to choose our representatives carefully by judging their caliber and potential, than complain and regret later about their unsatisfactory performance and failure to fulfill the expectations of the citizens.

The author is Assistant Professor of Political Science, Indian Institute of Legal Studies, Mumbai.

This basic definition allows students to distinguish between democracies and other non-democratic forms of government. For example, the army rulers who rule people in Myanmar have not been elected by the people.





In monarchies like Nepal and Saudi Arabia, rulers are not elected. This post is inherited by them because they were born in royal families. People or their will plays no role in this. Similar is the case of Pinochet, the military dictator of Chile. He was not elected by the people.

However, this basic definition is inadequate. It implies that every political system where elections are held to choose the leader is a democracy. That is not the case. All governments, whether democratic or non-democratic, want to be referred to as democratic to earn more legitimacy. Thus, it becomes essential to establish clear differences that can be employed to distinguish a real democracy from other political systems.



*The famous cartoon drawn in the run up to the elections in Iraq*

**Example 1.** Mention two important elements of the definition of democracy.

**Ans.** Two important elements of the definition of democracy are as follows:

- (1) Leaders of a democratic government are chosen.
- (2) These political leaders are voted and chosen by people through elections.

**Example 2.** Given below are a few of the famous definitions of democracy. Research about them online and find who said or wrote them.

- (A) Democracy gives every man the right to be his oppressor.
- (B) Democracy consists of choosing your dictators after they've told you what you think it is you want to hear.

- (C) Man's capacity for justice makes democracy possible, but man's inclination to injustice makes democracy necessary.
- (D) Democracy is a device that ensures we shall be governed no better than we deserve.
- (E) All the ills of democracy can be cured by more democracy.
- [NCERT]

**Ans. (A)** It was said by James Russell Lowell.

**(B)** The given lines about democracy were said by Alan Coren.

**(C)** The above lines about democracy were said by Reinhold Niebuhr.

**(D)** The given lines were said by George Bernard Shaw.

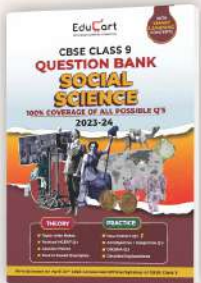
**(E)** The given words about democracy were said by Alfred Emanuel Smith.

•  
•  
•



To continue with remaining topics of this Chapter, **click below** to purchase the complete book at a special discount.

View Book





## Glossary

- (1) Civil society:** It refers to organizations and groups working for a cause or group of people. It functions outside the governmental setup.
- (2) Coup:** It refers to the seizure of power in a political system and the process is characterized by suddenness and illegality.

•  
•  
•

## OBJECTIVE Type Questions

### Multiple Choice Questions

[ 1 mark ]

1. Identify the country that is not a democracy.

- (a) India
- (b) Australia
- (c) America
- (d) North Korea

**Ans.** (d) North Korea

**Explanation:** A democratic political system is characterized by the election of political representatives by the citizens themselves. Australia, India, and America are very popular democracies of the world. North Korea has the dubious distinction of being a dictatorship.

2. Observe the given image and answer the following question.



What does the crown on the top of the allegory of democracy signify?

- (a) Independence
- (b) Victory
- (c) Liberty
- (d) Growth

**Ans.** (b) Victory

**Explanation:** This crown of leaves around the head of the allegory of democracy is a sign of victory.

## Fill in the Blanks

Fill in the blanks with suitable information.

3. India holds an election for the post of the president every 5 years. Similarly, Mexico has been holding elections to elect its president every ..... years.

**Ans.** Six

**Explanation:** Mexico has been holding elections for the post of the president every 6 years. Since 1930 and until 2000 only one party has been in power in Mexico despite regular elections.

## True or False

State whether the statement is true or false. If false, correct the statement.

4. Each citizen of India aged 21 years or above is equally entitled to vote.

**Ans.** False

Each citizen of India aged 18 years or above is equally entitled to vote.

**Explanation:** The legal age to vote in India is 18. Every citizen above the age of 18 years can vote in the elections and choose a political representative of his choice.



### Related Theory

→ India ensured a “universal adult franchise” to its citizens through the constitution. When India decided to grant a universal adult franchise, it was a revolutionary step.

## Match the Columns

5. Match the following items in column I with those in column II.

| Column I                                                                                | Column II                   |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| (A) Status of Ravi as a citizen is equal to that of Apoorv.                             | (i) Free and fair elections |
| (B) Every citizen in the country has a chance and right to vote for his representative. | (ii) Rule of law            |



|                                                                                           |                                                                   |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| (C) Only Mr. Agarwal, as the PM of the country, can decide if he will import rice or not. | (iii) Every citizen must have a choice to choose a representative |
| (D) General elections should be held at the same time for the entire country              | (iv) Elected representatives must make final decisions            |

**Codes:**

- (a) (A)-(iii), (B)-(iv), (C)-(i), (D)-(ii)
- (b) (A)-(ii), (B)-(iii), (C)-(iv), (D)-(i)
- (c) (A)-(ii), (B)-(iv), (C)-(i), (D)-(iii)
- (d) (A)-(iv), (B)-(iii), (C)-(ii), (D)-(i)

**Ans.** (A) (A)-(ii), (B)-(iii), (C)-(iv), (D)-(i)

### Assertion-Reason (A-R)

In the following questions, two statements in the form of an Assertion (A) and a Reason (R) have been put forward. Read both statements carefully and choose the most appropriate option:

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (b) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- (c) (A) is true but (R) is false.
- (d) (A) is false but (R) is true.

**6. Assertion (A):** Zimbabwe is widely considered a non-democratic country.

**Reason (R):** All the election in Zimbabwe have been won by the ZANU-PF party since the country's independence.

**Ans.** (a) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).

**Explanation:** ZANU-PF has been in power since the country's independence. Robert Mugabe was the most popular leader of this party. However, it is widely accepted that the party has been using unfair means to stay in power. Mugabe died in 2019.





### Related Theory

- “Freedom of the world index” is released by “Freedom House” and it evaluates the degree of liberty in countries and thus reflects upon the level of democracy in countries. The index lists only 11 African Countries as “free” under the index. Such is the condition of democracy in the African Continent.

## CASE BASED Questions (CBQS)

[ 4 & 5 marks ]

**Read the following passages and answer the questions that follow.**

7. Zimbabwe is a country located in the southern part of the African continent. Its record on democracy is fishy. It got independence in 1980 from the European white minority. ZANU-PF was the party that led the freedom movement and the country has been run by only this party since independence. Robert Mugabe was the party's leader and he ruled the country ever since its independence. Although Mugabe was popular in the beginning, it is widely accepted that he employed unfair practices to win elections. Elections took place regularly. Gradually his government introduced legislation and amended the constitution many times to decrease his accountability and increase his powers. The government declared all demonstrations and protests against itself illegal. Opposition parties were harassed and discriminated against. There was a law in place to curtail the right to criticise the president. Media including television and radio were controlled by the government and they propagated the government's propaganda and version of events. Although independent newspapers did exist, government harassed them and made it extremely difficult for them to run. The anti-government journalists were punished in some or the other way. The government even pressured the judiciary and if at some judgment went slightly against the government, the government ignored it. It was in 2017 that Mugabe was forced out of office.

**(A) How was Mugabe able to stay in power for so long in Zimbabwe?**

- (a) He was immensely popular throughout his tenure.
- (b) He was elected through completely fair elections.



- (c) He used unfair means during elections.
  - (d) He was loved by the people of neighbouring nations.
- (B) Mugabe was the leader of the ZANU-PF party which ruled Zimbabwe. Why was Mugabe popular in the beginning?
- (a) Because Mugabe was the only leader.
  - (b) Because Mugabe freed Zimbabwe alone.
  - (c) Because Mugabe was a common man.
  - (d) Because Mugabe led the political party which brought Zimbabwe freedom.
- (C) Assertion (A): Zimbabwe under Mugabe cannot be called a democracy.
- Reason (R): Media was controlled and elections were manipulated in Zimbabwe under Mugabe. The elections were unfair.
- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
  - (b) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
  - (c) (A) is true but (R) is false.
  - (d) (A) is false but (R) is true.
- (D) Mugabe gained power by misusing the government and constitution. How was this made possible?
- (a) Government gave him absolute power.
  - (b) Government aided in increasing his power.
  - (c) Mugabe declared a coup.
  - (d) Mugabe won over the opposition party.

**Ans.** (A) (c) *He used unfair means during elections.*

**Explanation:** Mugabe was popular in the beginning, but he lost his popularity as time passed. He was not elected through free and fair elections. He used unfair means to secure power for him again and again. The government declared all demonstrations and protests against itself illegal. Thus, he used unfair means to stay in power.

(B) (d) *Because Mugabe led the political party which brought Zimbabwe freedom.*

**Explanation:** Mugabe was the leader of the political party that led the movement for the freedom struggle before independence. Thus, he was quite popular in the beginning.

(C) (a) *Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).*

(D) (b) *Government aided in increasing his power.*

**Explanation:** Gradually, his government introduced legislation and amended the constitution many times to decrease his accountability and increase his powers.

### VERY SHORT ANSWER Type Questions (VSA)

[ 1 mark ]

**8. Which is the most common form of democracy prevalent in the world?**

**Ans.** Representative democracy is the most prevalent form of democracy. India has adopted it.



#### Related Theory

→ Other countries that have representative forms of democracy are the United Kingdom, the United States of America, Canada, Australia, New Zealand, etc.

### SHORT ANSWER Type-I Questions (SA-I)

[ 2 marks ]

**9. Various types of political systems are prevalent in today's world. Discuss two basic tenets of dictatorship.**

**Ans.** (1) Dictatorship is a type of political system in which absolute authority is held by a single person or a group of persons.

(2) It is marked by the absence of constitutional limitations on the exercise of power by these persons.



#### Related Theory

→ India's northern neighbour Nepal was also a dictatorship under the rule of a king before 2008.



## SHORT ANSWER Type-II Questions (SA-II)

[ 3 marks ]

**10. Compare the features of democratic governments with that of non-democratic governments.**

| Ans. | Democratic government                                       | Non-democratic government                                                                                            |
|------|-------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|      | (1) Marked by equality of opportunity for all citizens      | Marked by a kind of spoils system which prefers a certain group of people or communities to fill all important posts |
|      | (2) Ensures equal rights and representation to all citizens | Appeases a certain community or class, Influenced by a group of rich or powerful people                              |
|      | (3) Make the people residing in a nation- citizens          | Treats the people living in a nation- citizens                                                                       |



### Related Theory

- Spoils system is also known as the patronage system. It is a practice of giving public offices to supporters and confidantes of the party or person in power.

## LONG ANSWER Type Questions (LA)

[ 4 & 5 marks ]

**11. Describe the type of government prevalent in your country. How is it different from a direct democracy?**

**Ans.** India is a representative democracy. It is different from direct democracy in the following ways:

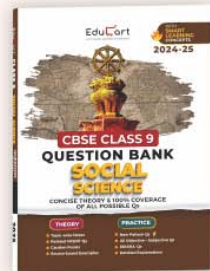
- (1) People here do not directly take decisions themselves in a representative democracy.
- (2) Representative democracy is marked by the presence of a political system where ordinary citizens participate in general elections to choose their representatives and these representatives finally take decisions on behalf of the citizens.

- (3) On the other hand, in direct democracy people themselves vote to indicate their preferences regarding decisions taken by the government regularly, that is, they directly make decisions.
- (4) Direct democracy is suitable for places with less population while representative democracies are suitable for countries with large populations.



For 100+ more such Questions  
(including PYQ and CBSE pattern &  
DIKSHA platform Q's),  
**please click** the below button.

[View Book](#)





“ I relied on NCERT for my learning. But I practiced from Educart One Shot Books to cover new pattern Qs and PYQs. ”

**SABYASACHI LASKAR**

CBSE TOPPER 2023-24  
(100%)



According to the CBSE topper, New pattern Qs Practice of all types and competencies are must in **Class 9** as well for each Chapter. Keeping this in mind, our Educart books cover everything important from all reference books in one place:

- ✓ Chapters divided into NCERT, PYQs and Competency
- ✓ Official Annual Exam Qs of prominent CBSE Schools (PYQs)
- ✓ Answers given separately at end for self-attempt
- ✓ Every theory point and figure summarised in Theory Maps



**BUY**

on Special Discount



**Rita Gupta**

HOD, Social Science  
Reputed CBSE School

*These One Shot books are the best reference books that every CBSE student should have so they can cover each Chapter in a structured manner, along with school teaching. The best part I found is the quality of answers & coverage all possible Questions*

*I scored 99.2% studying from Educart One Shot books. They know exactly what the students need and it really helped me do focused NCERT-driven revision and practice. A must buy book!!!*



**Arun Sharma**

Regional Topper  
CBSE 2022-23